



FREE GUIDE

The Quick-Start Playbook

5 mistakes to avoid before you ever pick up a buffer

THE AUTO DETAILING ACADEMY

INTRODUCTION

Most beginners don't fail because they can't learn the skill.

They fail because they make the same five mistakes in the first month — mistakes that cost them money, time, and confidence before they ever get good.

This isn't theory. It's what actually trips people up, from someone who runs a real detailing shop and has spent years teaching for a living.

Five mistakes. Read them once, and you'll skip past what usually takes a beginner months — or a few ruined jobs — to figure out.

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- Runs an active detailing business
 - Trained, working classroom teacher

MISTAKE 01

Buying too many products

You don't need forty bottles on a shelf. You need a handful of products you actually understand how to use.

Beginners raid every detailing forum and buy everything recommended, then spend more time confused about which product does what than actually detailing.

Start with the basics — a good soap, a couple of microfiber towels, a wax or sealant, an all-purpose cleaner — and learn those cold before adding anything else.

This is exactly what the Academy's starter kit breaks down — the go-tos, nothing more, so you can start doing real details instead of shopping.

MISTAKE 02

Chasing advanced techniques too early

Ceramic coating and paint correction look impressive on video, so that's what beginners want to learn first.

But those techniques build on fundamentals — wash technique, surface prep, understanding paint — that most beginners skip past entirely.

Jumping straight to advanced work without the basics means you're more likely to damage paint than fix it.

MISTAKE 03

Pricing yourself too low

New detailers routinely underprice their work because they're only thinking about product cost, not their time.

A detail that takes you three hours needs to be priced for three hours, not just the cost of the soap and towels.

Undercharging doesn't just hurt your income — it trains your customers to expect rock-bottom prices, which makes it harder to raise them later.

MISTAKE 04

Believing the social media noise

Detailing content online makes it look like you need flawless technique, a ceramic coating certification, and \$300 full details just to make money.

You don't.

Plenty of detailers build solid, profitable businesses on solid basics done consistently well — not on chasing whatever's trending this week.

MISTAKE 05

Trying to do everything solo instead of systemizing

Every job takes twice as long as it should when you're figuring out your process from scratch each time.

A simple checklist — the same steps, the same order, every job — is what turns detailing from a hobby into something you can actually run like a business.



THAT'S THE PLAYBOOK

Five mistakes down. One course to go.

These are the mistakes that cost beginners the most time and money — and they're completely avoidable once you know what to watch for. This is just the start.

Inside the Academy's flagship course, you'll get the full system: the exact starter kit, the step-by-step technique, and the business side most courses skip entirely.

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